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Week 5 Lit Example Worksheet

JULIUS CAESAR: BRUTUS, ANTONY, AND FORMAL SHAPE

Purpose: Apply Week 5's Whately method to Julius Caesar. Identify mood and formal validity before judging factual strength.

Directions: Use the Lit Example Reader. Your answers should distinguish form test from evidence test.

Part 1: Brutus's Form

Question 1.1

Reconstruct Brutus's argument in three claims: major premise, minor premise, and conclusion.

Part 1 Q1

Question 1.2

State the mood of your three claims (A, E, I, or O for each). Is the form valid if written as All M are P; All S are M; therefore All S are P?

Part 1 Q2

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Part 2: Middle Term and Figure

Question 2.1

Identify S, P, and M in Brutus's formal map. Then write the figure pattern using S, P, and M.

Part 2 Q1

Question 2.2

Does Brutus's formal shape by itself prove that Caesar was dangerously ambitious? Explain the difference between valid form and proved premise.

Part 2 Q2

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Part 3: Antony's Reply

Question 3.1

List Antony's three pieces of evidence against the claim that Caesar was dangerously ambitious.

Part 3 Q1

Question 3.2

Does Antony give a cleaner formal syllogism than Brutus, or does he mainly attack Brutus's minor premise? Explain.

Part 3 Q2

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Part 4: Formal Judgment

Question 4.1

Write one possible syllogism for Antony's reasoning. Then name its mood if possible and say whether the conclusion follows from your premises.

Part 4 Q1

Question 4.2

Which speaker gives the stronger form? Which gives stronger evidence against the pressure-point premise? Explain the difference.

Part 4 Q2